Earth and Planets · Pupil Resources

Learning goal: I can describe the Sun, Earth, and Moon as spheres and explain what orbits what in our solar system.

Arrival Questions (In your book)

1. What 3D shape are the Sun, Earth, and Moon?
2. Does the Earth orbit the Sun, or does the Sun orbit the Earth?
3. What object orbits the Earth?
4. Can you ask an adult to help?

Starter Question

Why do all eight planets stay in curved orbits around the Sun instead of flying off in a straight line?

A. The force of gravity between the huge Sun and each planet pulls them into orbit.

B. Giant invisible strings tie the planets to the Sun.

C. Air resistance in space pushes them round.

Method Strip

1. Place the Sun card at the left of your desk mat.
2. Lay the eight planet cards in order from closest to furthest from the Sun. STOP AND CHECK.
3. Group the first four as Inner Rocky Planets and the next four as Outer Giant Planets.
4. Place the Moon card on its orbit ring around the Earth.

5. Draw and label the Sun, Earth, and Moon orbits in your book.

Exit Ticket

What 3D word describes the shape of the Sun, Earth, and Moon?

List the first four planets in order from the Sun.

Explain what the Earth orbits and what the Moon orbits.